



PTI

## Suhas Yathiraj becomes World No. 1 para shuttler



Indian para shuttler Suhas Yathiraj became the world number one player, displacing French legend Lucas Mazur in the latest BWF Para Badminton World Rankings. The 40-year-old Arjuna awardee had won the silver medal in the SL-4 category at the Tokyo Paralympics, losing the title clash to Mazur.

Suhas has now amassed 60,527 points, leaving behind his French rival (58953).

"Finally, World Number 1. Happy to share that, in the latest Badminton World Federation Para Badminton rankings announced for Men's Singles category, I have got world number 1 ranking.

"First time in life, replacing previously long standing world number 1 Lucas Mazur of France. Thanks a lot for your blessings and wishes," wrote Suhas on 'X'.

Suhas, an IAS officer of the Uttar Pradesh cadre, had won the World Championship title defeating Fredy Setiawan of Indonesia in February this year.

SL-4 category in para badminton is for players with movement affected at a low level on one side of the body, in both legs, or the minor absence of one limb. They play standing on a full-width court and have good court movement and a full range of shots.

TEAM SPORTSTAR

## » INDIAN PLAYGROUND

### SPORTOON



**1** The Basketball Federation of India (BFI) has signed a seven-year deal with ACG Sports Limited, with a guarantee of Rs. 216.30 crore for hosting the National State Basketball League for men and women. The president of BFI, Aadhav Arjuna said that for each year, the amount would be 20.6 crore rupees for the 5x5 format and 10.3 crore rupees for the 3x3 format. "It was a transparent system, and we gave it to the highest bidder. It is a medical group of companies, and has already been associated with supporting basketball through many events", said the BFI president.

KAMESH SRINIVASAN

**2** The State government of Odisha announced an extension of its support to Hockey India by another three years till 2036. This partnership was solidified in a high-level meeting attended by Hockey India President Dr. Dilip Tirkey and Hockey India Secretary General Bhola Nath Singh, with the Chief Minister of Odisha Mohan Charan Majhi, Minister of State for Sports & Youth Services Suryabanshi Suraj, Chief Secretary & Chief Development Commissioner Pradeep Kumar Jena, IAS, and Commissioner-Cum-Secretary R. Vineel Krishna, IAS.

TEAM SPORTSTAR